

Segment 15 – County Road 550 to Wetmore Landing

(Formerly Segment #14), updated January 2025. [Google Map of Segment 15](#) The Google Map is only for an overview of the trail. **Use Avenza Maps for actually locating and following the trail.**

Trail Adopter: Emily & Bill Mason, 616 302-2588, emily.mason6088@gmail.com

Segment length: 1.1 miles, south to north 146 ft ascent, 269 ft descent

Link to [Avenza Maps Online](#) Use Map # 42 in the Avenza app. Make sure you have the current updates for Avenza. Always refer to the updated Avenza Maps for the most current NCT mile markers.

Please contact the Trail Crew Leader (Bob Weisenberger, 906 361-4033, rweisenber@gmail.com) or the Trail Adopter above with reports of trail conditions, including blowdowns, washouts or inadequate blazing, or if you have questions on driving directions to the start point.

Many of the backroads have multiple names depending on which map you are using. When known, multiple names for the same road have been indicated in italics within brackets.

On the trail: (for this segment, trail description will be northbound, follow in reverse for southbound.)

This segment takes you to a spur trail to Sugarloaf Mountain, before coming out along Lake Superior. From the parking area on CR 550 (46.609924,-87.469560), follow the blazes up a hill and through some interesting rocky sections before descending (including some steps) to beautiful majestic pines following the Lake Superior shoreline. The segment ends at (46.615061,-87.465084), the intersection of the trail to the Wetmore Landing parking area off of CR 550. The beautiful beach at Wetmore Landing is a great place to cool off on a hot day!

Driving Directions:

Southern Trailhead

From the corner of Hawley St./Lakeshore Boulevard in Marquette, head west for 4.8 miles on Hawley St. which turns into [*County Road (CR) 550/Big Bay Rd*]. Watch for signs for the NCT crossing. There is no actual parking area but there is a little pull off where the trail crosses [*CR 550/Big Bay Rd*] just before the guardrail. This is a very busy road so be sure to pull as far off as possible. For those who prefer to follow a Google Map, here is the [Driving map from Lakeshore Blvd/Wright St to CR 550 parking](#)

Northern Trailhead

From the corner of Hawley St./Lakeshore Boulevard in Marquette, head west for 5.2 miles on Hawley St. which turns into [*County Road (CR) 550/Big Bay Rd*]. Watch for the sign that says “Little Presque Isle Recreation Area, Wetmore Landing Day Use Area”. There is parking on either side of [*CR 550/Big Bay Rd*]. From the parking area on the east side of the road, follow the trail to the lake where you join the NCT. For a driving map to this location, follow the map to the southern trailhead, and continue an additional .4 miles.

Camping:

No camping is allowed on this segment. The DNR has cabins that they rent at Presque Isle, near Segment 16. [Little Presque Isle Cabins](#)

Water Access:

Water is available all along the shoreline of Lake Superior.

Seasonal Access Information:

A [Michigan Recreation Passport](#) is required to park at the northern trailhead. All roads are accessible via vehicle year-round. Parking on the east side of [*CR 550/Big Bay Rd*] may be hindered by snow in the wintertime; parking on the west side of [*CR 550/Big Bay Rd*] at Wetmore Landing is usually a better choice in the wintertime.